

SOC L1 Alert Reporting: -

Task 1: - Introduction

(Learn how to properly report, escalate and communicate about high risk SOC alerts)

During or after alert triage, L1 analysis may be uncertain about how to classify the alert, requiring senior support or information from system owners. Also, L1 may deal with real cyberattacks and breaches that need immediate actions. This room covers these cases by introducing new terms: alert reporting, escalation, and communication.

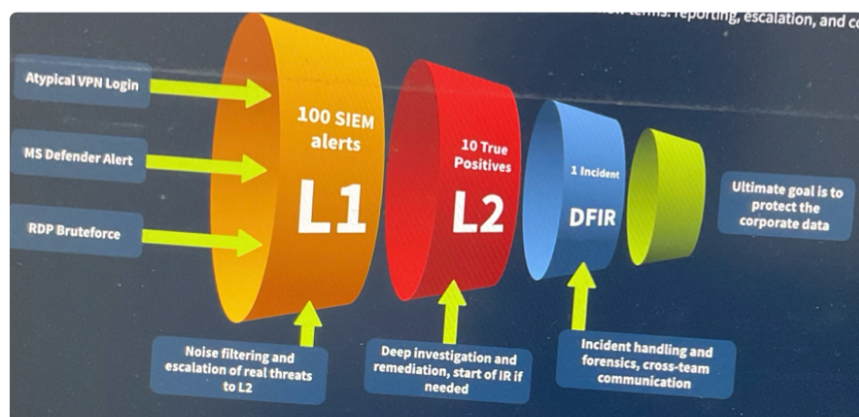
Learning Objectives: -

- Understand the need for SOC alert reporting and escalation
- Explore escalation methods and communication best practices
- Learn how to write alert comments or case reports properly
- Apply the knowledge to triage alerts in simulated environment
- Feel more confident in SOC simulator during SMLI certification

Task 2: - Alert Funnel

In the previous you learned how to classify and triage the alerts. But you might be curious about what happens next. How does your triage help prevent threats and stop breaches? But now let's recall the path of alerts.

First L1 analysis receive the alerts in SIEM, EDR or ticket management platform. Most of alerts are closed as false positive or are handled on L1 level, but complex and threatening ones are sent to L2 that remediate most breaches. And sent alerts, furthermore, you need to learn 3 terms: - reporting, escalation and communication.



Alert Reporting: -

Before closing or passing the alert to L2, you might have to report it. Depending on team standards and alert severity. Instead of short alert comment, you can be required to

document your investigation in detail, ensuring all relevant evidence is included. This is especially important for True positives, which require escalation.

Alert Escalation:-

If the True positive alert required additional actions or deeper investigation, escalate it to the L2 analyst for further review following agreed procedures. That's where you are alert report comes in handy since L2 will use it to get initial context and spend less on analysis from scratch.

Communication:-

You may also need to communicate with other departments during or after the analysis. For example, ask IT team if they confirm granting administrative privileges to some users or Contact HR to get more information about newly hired employees.

Quiz:-

10) What is process of passing suspicious alerts to L2 analyst for review?

A) Alert Escalation

20) What is process of formally describing alert details and findings?

A) Alert Reporting

Task 3:- Reporting Guide

Before we move on, it is essential to clarify why anyone would want L1 analysts to write reports in addition to marking them as True or False positives and why this topic can not be underestimated.

Having L1 analysts write alert reports serves several key purposes:-

Alert Report purpose	Explanation
Provide context for escalation	* A well written report saves lots of time for L2 analysts * Also, it helps them quickly understand what happened
Save findings for the records	* Raw SIEM logs are stored in 3-12 months, but alerts are kept indefinitely * As a result, it's better to keep all content inside the alert, just in case
Improve investigation skills	* If you can't explain it simply, you don't understand it well enough * Report writing is great way to boost L1 skills by summarizing alerts

Report Format:- Imagine yourself as an L2 analyst, a DFIR team member, or an IT professional who needs to understand the alert. What would you want to see in the report? ...

recommend you follow 5 W's approach and include at least these items in the reports:

* Who :- which user logs in, runs the command, or downloads the file

* What :- what Exact action or event sequence was performed.

* When :- When exactly did the suspicious activity start and ended.

* Where :- which device, IP or website was involved in alert.

* Why :- The most important W, the reasoning for your final verdict.

ALERT REPORT CHECKLIST	
✓ All 5Ws are included in the report	
✓ Alert report is clear and precise	
✓ Alert report forms a single timeline	
✓ Evidence and indicators are attached	
✓ Escalation reason to L2 is explained	

Double-Extension File Creation	
Status	Verdict
Closed	True Positive
Severity	Assignee
High	J.Adams (L2)
Comment	
At 13:56 UTC, the user S.Conway (Susan Conway, HR Coordinator) accessed the phishing website freecatvideoshd1monster from their LPT-HR-009 Windows laptop. At 13:58 UTC, the user downloaded a file from there named cats2025.mp4.exe, likely mistaking it for a legitimate video. VirusTotal reports confirm that the file is LummaStealer malware, aimed to exfiltrate sensitive data and establish a C2 channel. Further malware actions require deeper investigation, so escalating the alert to L2 and sharing the SIEM findings: > https://siem.tryhackme.thm/XgqnU	